

CONTRIBUTOR AGREEMENT AND
INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY ASSIGNMENT

AAES-OS – Adaptive Autonomous Executive System Operating System

Between:	Jon Adams Halstead ("Founder") – Creator, Owner, and Principal Architect of AAES-OS
And:	[Contributor's Full Legal Name] ("Contributor") – Collaborating Developer

Effective Date: 6-16-2026

Recitals

WHEREAS, Jon Adams Halstead (the "Founder") has developed AAES-OS, a proprietary constitutional AI governance architecture encompassing its design specifications, frameworks, doctrines, and all related system materials, and is the sole creator and owner thereof;

WHEREAS, the Contributor desires to make technical contributions to the AAES-OS project under the terms and conditions set forth in this Agreement;

WHEREAS, the parties have previously executed a Mutual Non-Disclosure Agreement governing the treatment of confidential information exchanged in connection with AAES-OS, which agreement continues in full force and effect;

WHEREAS, this Agreement is the second layer of the AAES-OS legal governance stack, situated above the Non-Disclosure Agreement and below the contemplated Governance Agreement, and governs the ownership, licensing, and

governance of all intellectual property created by or with the Contributor in connection with AAES-OS; and

NOW, THEREFORE, in consideration of the mutual covenants and agreements set forth herein, and for other good and valuable consideration, the receipt and sufficiency of which are hereby acknowledged, the parties agree as follows.

SECTION 1 — DEFINITIONS

1.1 "AAES-OS" means the Adaptive Autonomous Executive System Operating System, including its constitutional architecture, governance frameworks, doctrines, system models, source code, and all related materials, owned exclusively by Jon Adams Halstead.

1.2 "Founder Architecture" means the original constitutional design, frameworks, doctrines, system models, governance specifications, and architectural blueprints created by or attributable to Jon Adams Halstead, whether created before or during this collaboration. Founder Architecture is not subject to any contribution claim.

1.3 "Contributor Work" means any code, module, framework, algorithm, documentation, improvement, invention, or other work product created by Contributor during the term of this Agreement within the scope of approved AAES-OS contributions.

1.4 "Commercial Asset" means any product, service, deployment, platform, customer-facing system, licensing arrangement, or revenue-generating activity built upon or derived from AAES-OS.

1.5 "Contribution Artifact" means a structured record documenting a Contributor Work submission as defined in Section 5.

1.6 "Approved Scope" means the specific modules, components, or work areas authorized for Contributor's work, as defined in a written Scope Authorization issued by the Founder.

SECTION 2 — INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY OWNERSHIP

2.1 Pre-Existing IP — Founder. The Founder Architecture and all intellectual property created by Jon Adams Halstead prior to or outside the scope of this Agreement remains the sole and exclusive property of Jon Adams Halstead. This Agreement does not transfer, assign, or encumber any Founder Architecture or pre-existing IP.

2.2 Pre-Existing IP — Contributor. All intellectual property created by Contributor prior to or independently of this Agreement remains the sole property of Contributor and is not transferred to the Founder by this Agreement. Contributor shall identify any pre-existing IP incorporated into Contributor Work in the relevant Contribution Artifact.

2.3 Assignment of Contributor Work. Contributor hereby irrevocably assigns to Jon Adams Halstead all right, title, and interest in and to all Contributor Work created within the Approved Scope of this Agreement, including all intellectual property rights therein (patent, copyright, trade secret, and otherwise), effective upon creation. Contributor agrees to execute any documents reasonably requested to perfect or record this assignment.

2.4 Work Made For Hire. To the extent any Contributor Work qualifies as a "work made for hire" under applicable copyright law, it shall be so treated. To the extent it does not, Contributor hereby assigns all rights therein to Jon Adams Halstead pursuant to Section 2.3.

2.5 Inventions and Improvements. Any invention, discovery, improvement, or innovation conceived or reduced to practice by Contributor during the term of this Agreement in connection with AAES-OS — whether or not patentable — is included in the definition of Contributor Work and is assigned to the Founder under Section 2.3.

2.6 Contribution ≠ Architectural Ownership. The assignment of Contributor Work does not confer any ownership, authorship claim, or governance authority over Founder Architecture. Contribution does not automatically equal architectural ownership. Contributor expressly waives any claim to ownership of, or authority over, the AAES-OS architectural blueprint, constitutional documents, or governance specifications by virtue of any contribution made under this Agreement.

For clarity: a Contributor may author code integrated into AAES-OS while holding no architectural ownership, authorship credit over foundational design documents, or governance authority whatsoever. The Founder Architecture remains exclusively and inalienably vested in Jon Adams Halstead.

SECTION 3 — ARCHITECT AUTHORITY AND GOVERNANCE BOUNDARY

3.1 Founder Authority. The AAES-OS architecture blueprint, constitutional documents, and governance specifications are and shall remain the exclusive domain of the Founder. They constitute the source of truth for all implementation decisions.

3.2 Contributor Scope. Contributors operate strictly within Approved Scope boundaries established by the Founder. No contributor, developer, AI coding agent, or external tool may:

- (a) Redefine or modify core AAES-OS architecture without explicit written approval from the Founder;
- (b) Remove, bypass, or weaken any governance layer, validation system, or evidence requirement;
- (c) Modify system invariants without a formal change authorization issued by the Founder;
- (d) Introduce architectural drift — any deviation from approved structural patterns — without prior written authorization.

3.3 Governance Chain. All work within AAES-OS operates under the following authority hierarchy:

**Governing Law → Founder Architecture Blueprint → This Agreement
→ Implementation → Pipelines → Tools**

3.4 Conflict Resolution. In the event of any conflict between Contributor Work and the Founder Architecture, the Founder Architecture prevails. The Founder has final

authority to require modification, rollback, or rejection of any Contributor Work that conflicts with the architectural blueprint or governance specifications.

SECTION 4 — LICENSING RIGHTS

4.1 License Back to Contributor. The Founder grants Contributor a limited, non-exclusive, non-transferable, royalty-free license to use Contributor Work solely for the purpose of performing contributions under this Agreement during its term. This license terminates upon expiration or termination of this Agreement.

4.2 No Sublicensing. Contributor may not sublicense, transfer, or grant any rights in Contributor Work or Founder Architecture to any third party.

4.3 Attribution License. The Founder grants Contributor the right to list their participation in AAES-OS development as a professional credential, subject to the confidentiality obligations of the NDA and the attribution rules in Section 7 of this Agreement.

SECTION 5 — ARTIFACT GOVERNANCE AND CONTRIBUTION RECORDS

5.1 Mandatory Artifact Record. Every meaningful contribution shall be documented by Contributor in a Contribution Artifact prior to or concurrent with integration. Each Contribution Artifact shall include:

- (a) Contributor identity and date of contribution;
- (b) Timestamp of creation and submission;
- (c) Description of the change, module, or feature contributed;
- (d) Affected modules and system components;
- (e) Dependency impact assessment;
- (f) Validation status (tested, pending, approved, rejected); and
- (g) Rollback path or reversal procedure.

5.2 Evidentiary Purpose. Contribution Artifacts constitute the official record of development history and serve as evidence of contribution scope, ownership, and approval status. They are owned by the Founder and form part of the AAES-OS governance record.

5.3 Retention. Contribution Artifacts shall be retained for the duration of this Agreement and for a minimum of seven (7) years following termination.

5.4 Founder Approval. No Contributor Work shall be integrated into AAES-OS without written approval from the Founder or an authorized delegate. Unapproved contributions do not transfer under Section 2.3 and do not grant Contributor any rights.

SECTION 6 — COMMERCIALIZATION RIGHTS AND RESTRICTIONS

6.1 Founder Commercialization Authority. Jon Adams Halstead holds exclusive authority over all commercialization of AAES-OS, including the right to:

- (a) License AAES-OS or any component thereof;
- (b) Create, launch, or authorize Commercial Assets;
- (c) Represent AAES-OS publicly, enter commercial partnerships, and negotiate customer agreements; and
- (d) Determine pricing, revenue models, and distribution channels.

6.2 No Contributor Commercialization Rights. Contributor shall not, without express written authorization from the Founder:

- (a) Commercialize, sublicense, or distribute Contributor Work or any AAES-OS component;
- (b) Create any product, service, or platform that incorporates or is derived from AAES-OS materials;
- (c) Represent AAES-OS to customers, partners, investors, or the public; or
- (d) Enter any agreement purportedly on behalf of AAES-OS.

6.3 Revenue Participation (Optional). If the Founder elects to offer revenue participation to Contributor for specific Commercial Assets, such participation shall be governed by a separate Revenue Participation Addendum executed in writing by both parties. Revenue participation, if offered, does not confer ownership or governance authority.

SECTION 7 — ATTRIBUTION RULES

7.1 Founder Attribution. Jon Adams Halstead shall be credited as the sole creator and architect of AAES-OS in all public, commercial, and official contexts.

7.2 Contributor Attribution. Contributor may acknowledge their role as a contributing developer to AAES-OS in professional contexts (resumes, portfolios, professional profiles), provided such acknowledgment:

- (a) Does not disclose Confidential Information protected under the NDA;
- (b) Does not imply co-authorship, co-ownership, or architectural authority over AAES-OS; and
- (c) Does not characterize the nature, capabilities, or design of AAES-OS beyond what is publicly disclosed.

7.3 No Unauthorized Publication. Contributor shall not publish, present, or otherwise disclose any technical details of AAES-OS in papers, talks, blog posts, social media, or other public channels without prior written consent from the Founder.

SECTION 8 — TERM AND TERMINATION

8.1 Term. This Agreement begins on the Effective Date and continues until terminated by either party with thirty (30) days' written notice, or immediately by the Founder upon material breach by Contributor.

8.2 Effect of Termination. Upon termination:

- (a) Contributor's license under Section 4.1 immediately terminates;

- (b) Contributor shall return or certify destruction of all AAES-OS materials in their possession;
- (c) All Contributor Work created prior to termination remains irrevocably assigned to the Founder; and
- (d) Sections 2, 3, 5, 6, 7, 9, and 10 survive termination indefinitely.

SECTION 9 — REPRESENTATIONS AND WARRANTIES

9.1 Contributor represents and warrants that:

- (a) Contributor has full legal authority to enter into this Agreement and to perform all obligations hereunder;
- (b) Contributor Work will be original and will not infringe any third party's intellectual property rights;
- (c) Contributor has not previously assigned or licensed any rights that would conflict with this Agreement; and
- (d) Contributor will promptly disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest to the Founder.

SECTION 10 — REMEDIES AND ENFORCEMENT

10.1 Breach. A breach of this Agreement — particularly of Sections 2, 3, 6, or 7 — may cause irreparable harm to the Founder for which monetary damages would be inadequate.

10.2 Equitable Relief. The Founder is entitled to seek injunctive relief, specific performance, and other equitable remedies in addition to any damages available at law, without the requirement of posting bond or other security.

10.3 Indemnification. Contributor shall indemnify and hold harmless Jon Adams Halstead from any claim, loss, damage, liability, cost, or expense (including reasonable attorneys' fees) arising from a breach of Contributor's representations, warranties, or obligations under this Agreement.

SECTION 11 — GOVERNING LAW AND DISPUTES

11.1 This Agreement shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the State of Michigan, United States of America, without regard to its conflict of law principles.

11.2 Any dispute arising under or relating to this Agreement shall first be subject to good-faith negotiation between the parties. If unresolved within thirty (30) days of written notice of the dispute, such dispute shall be submitted to binding arbitration in the State of Michigan under the rules of the American Arbitration Association. Judgment upon the arbitration award may be entered in any court of competent jurisdiction.

SECTION 12 — RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER AGREEMENTS

12.1 NDA. This Agreement supplements and does not replace the Mutual Non-Disclosure Agreement previously executed between the parties. In the event of conflict between this Agreement and the NDA regarding confidentiality obligations, the more protective provision applies.

12.2 Governance Agreement. The parties acknowledge that a Governance Agreement establishing authority boundaries and operational governance is contemplated as the third layer of the AAES-OS legal governance stack. This Agreement shall be interpreted consistently with any such Governance Agreement when executed.

12.3 Entire Agreement. This Agreement, together with the NDA and any duly executed Addenda, constitutes the entire agreement between the parties with respect to the subject matter herein and supersedes all prior discussions, understandings, and representations on these topics.

12.4 Amendments. This Agreement may only be amended by a written instrument signed by both parties. No oral modification shall have any force or effect.

12.5 Severability. If any provision of this Agreement is found to be unenforceable, that provision shall be modified to the minimum extent necessary to make it enforceable, and the remaining provisions shall continue in full force and effect.

12.6 Counterparts. This Agreement may be executed in counterparts, each of which shall be deemed an original, and all of which together shall constitute one and the same instrument. Electronic or digital signatures shall be deemed valid and binding.

SIGNATURES

By signing below, each party acknowledges they have read, understood, and agreed to be bound by the terms of this Contributor Agreement and Intellectual Property Assignment.

**Founder Signature: Jon Adams
Halstead Printed Name: Jon Adams
Halstead Jon Adams Halstead Title:
Founder & Principal Architect, AAES-OS
Date: 6-16-2026**

**Contributor Signature: Printed
Name: [Contributor's Full Legal Name]
Title: Collaborating Developer, AAES-OS
Date:**